



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Washington



Former Ellensburg Doctor Indicted on 26 Felony Counts for Falsifying and Issuing Commercial Driver's Licenses and Prescriptions for Controlled Substances Outside the Scope of Professional Practice and Not for a Legitimate Medical Purpose

Monday, December 1, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of Washington

Yakima, Washington – United States Attorney Pete Serrano announced that on November 14, 2025, a federal grand jury for the Eastern District of Washington returned an Indictment charging Anna Elperin, age 42, with 26 felony counts relating to prescriptions for controlled substances and Department of Transportation commercial driver's licenses physical examinations Elperin wrote and performed at her former clinic, Awake Health, PLLC, in Ellensburg, Washington, between July 2018 and September 2022.

Elperin was arrested by federal law enforcement officers on November 21, 2025, and made her initial appearance in federal magistrate court on November 24, 2025.

The Indictment alleges that Elperin was involved in two separate fraudulent schemes. First, Elperin falsified medical examinations for commercial driver's license applicants. According to court documents, Elperin, who was a trained and certified medical examiner eligible to perform Department of Transportation physicals, improperly performed physical examinations and then certified candidates for commercial driver's licenses were physically qualified for such licenses when they in fact were not. Moreover, Elperin failed to transmit data about the certifications she signed to the Department of Transportation as required. Second, Elperin issued false and fraudulent prescriptions for controlled

substances outside the scope of professional practice and for no legitimate medical purpose, occasionally prescribing her staff prescriptions which she herself would take from the staff member. According to court documents, Elperin had a pre-signed prescription pad at her clinic, Awake Health, and permitted staff members to write themselves prescriptions for controlled substances. Moreover, Elperin herself signed prescriptions for controlled substances for staff and others which Elperin then requested the individual return to Elperin for her own use.

"This investigation has been ongoing for a long time, and I am proud to work with such diligent investigative agencies who are focused on public safety, especially with the current environment of public concerns related to motor carrier qualifications and safety" stated Mr. Serrano.

Elperin has been charged with Conspiracy to Defraud the Department of Transportation (Count 1); Making a False Writing or Document (Counts 2-7); Falsification of Federal Records (Counts 8-13); Conspiracy to Dispense Controlled Substances and to Acquire Controlled Substances by Misrepresentation, Fraud, or Deception (Count 14); False Statements Relating to Health Care Matters (Counts 15-17); Dispensing and Distribution of Controlled Substances (Counts 18-22); and Acquiring or Obtaining a Controlled Substance by Misrepresentation, Fraud, or Deception (Counts 23-26).

A hearing for Elperin's detention pending trial was held on November 26, 2025. Prior to the detention hearing, the United States Attorney's Office filed two detention motions arguing for Elperin's detention. The United States proffered that Elperin was frequently visibly impaired at work at Awake Health and had threatened and intimidated staff members, including with a firearm. At the detention hearing, Magistrate Judge Alex C. Ekstrom highlighted that there was currently no evidence that any of Elperin's substance or alcohol abuse, which underlined the charged offenses, had been addressed. Judge Ekstrom further expressed concerns about Elperin's substance and alcohol use, mental health, and acts of ensconcing herself in her house to further her addiction. Magistrate Judge Ekstrom detained Elperin pending trial.

"This indictment highlights our unwavering commitment to exposing and pursuing fraudulent conduct by medical professionals in the motor carrier industry who are willing to jeopardize public safety," said Cory LeGars, Special Agent-in-Charge of the Department of Transportation Office of Inspector General, Western Region. "Working closely with our law enforcement and prosecutorial partners, we will continue to aggressively prevent, detect, and prosecute actions that undermine the integrity of DOT's safety programs."

"DEA holds physicians who prescribe controlled substances to a very high standard so they do not become drug dealers with a medical license," said David F. Reames, Special Agent in Charge, DEA Seattle Field Division. "Not only did Dr. Elperin fail to uphold this standard, in some instances she obtained the controlled substances for her personal use. We are proud of the work of DEA and our partners for holding her accountable."

Unrelated to the federal investigation, in December 2021 and September 2022, respectively, the Board of Osteopathic Medicine and Surgery and the Washington State Department of Health restricted Elperin's medical license.

This case is being investigated jointly by the Department of Transportation, Office of Inspector General, and the Drug Enforcement Administration. It is being prosecuted by Assistant United States Attorney Courtney R. Pratten, and contractor Echo D. Fatsis.

An indictment is merely an allegation, and all defendants are presumed innocent until proven guilty beyond a reasonable doubt in a court of law.

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More information can be found on the Washington State Department of Health Website:

<https://doh.wa.gov/newsroom/kittitas-county-osteopathic-physicians-license-suspended-based-additional-charges>.

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